Write About The Topic

Scoring Criteria

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Writing: Scoring Criteria

6.4 Extended Speaking and Writing Tasks

The writing and speaking tasks are scored by automated scoring algorithms developed by ML and NLP experts at Duolingo. There are two separate algorithms: one for the speaking tasks and one for the writing tasks. Currently, the scores for the tasks are estimated at the portfolio level—meaning that the speaking score that is included in the total score represents test taker performance on the four speaking tasks and the writing score represents test taker performance on the four writing tasks.

The speaking and writing scoring systems evaluate each task based on the features listed below.

- Grammatical accuracy
- Grammatical complexity
- Lexical sophistication
- Lexical diversity
- Task relevance
- Length
- Fluency & acoustic features (speaking)

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Writing: Scoring Criteria

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h task based on the features listed

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Writing: Scoring Criteria

Simplified

1. Grammatical accuracy & complexity
2. Vocabulary sophistication & diversity
3. Task relevance
4. Length
5. Fluency

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1. Grammar

- Mostly error-free sentences
- Wide range of grammar structures
- A variety of complex and simple structures

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Task

Example: ***Make some complex sentences***

I live in an apartment. I really like my apartment. It's modern. It's conveniently located. The apartment is in the city center. It's close to my school. It only takes me ten minutes to walk to school. The apartment is a bit small. I'd like to find a bigger one in the future.

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I live in an apartment. I really like my apartment. It's modern. It's conveniently located. The apartment is in the city center. It's close to my school. It only takes me ten minutes to walk to school. The apartment is a bit small. I'd like to find a bigger one in the future.

I live in an apartment, which I really like. It's modern and conveniently located. It is in the city center and close to my school. In fact, it only takes me ten minutes to walk there. Since the apartment is a bit small, I'd like to find a bigger one in the future.

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2. Vocabulary

- Wide range of vocabulary precisely *(synonyms)*
- Vocabulary that fits the style *(academic, formal)*
- Don't use contractions or slang

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2. Vocabulary

Example

Question: *University students should be required to attend all classes. Do you agree or disagree with this statement?*

*I agree that university **students** should be required to attend all **classes** for two reasons. One reason **students** should be required to attend **classes** is for discipline. Without the pressure of mandatory attendance, many **students** might think that **classes** are not important. Most university **students** are teenagers or in their early twenties, thus are still learning how to manage their lives…*

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*I agree that university **students** should be required to attend all **classes** for two reasons. One reason **students** should be required to attend **classes** is for discipline. Without the pressure of mandatory attendance, many **students** might think that **classes** are not important. Most university **students** are teenagers or in their early twenties, thus are still learning how to manage their lives…*

*I agree that university **students** should be required to attend all **classes** for two reasons. One reason **learners** should be required to attend **lessons** is for discipline. Without the pressure of mandatory attendance, many **students** might think that **lectures** are not important. Most **freshmen** are teenagers or in their early twenties, thus are still learning how to manage their lives…*

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3. Task Relevance

- Fully answer all parts of the prompt
- Provide supporting ideas
- Use topic related vocabulary

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4 & 5. Length & Fluency

- Write the minimum amount
- Try to write more if you can
- Linking phrases to connect ideas
- Correct spelling and punctuation